of our rulers was no matter of pride. What was remarkable, however, was the whole-hearted way in which we gave our recognition to human greatness even when it revealed itself in the foreigner. The best and noblest gifts of humanity cannot be the monopoly of a particular race or country; its scope may not be limited nor may it be regarded as the miser's hoard buried underground. That is why English literature which nourished our minds in the past, does even now convey its deep

resonance to the recesses of our heart.'

Tagore proceeds to refer to the Indian ideal of proper conduct prescribed by the tradition of the race. 'Narrow in themselves these time-honoured social conventions originated an held good in a circumscribed geographical area, in that strip o land, Brahmavarta by name, bound on either side by the rivers Saraswati and Drisadvati. That is how a pharisaic formalism gradually got the upper hand of free thought and the idea "proper conduct" which Manu found established in Brahmavarta steadily degenerated into socialized tyranny.

'During my boyhood days the attitude of the cultured and